Difficult People

How do I stay decent toward people who make it hard?

READING · ONE PARAGRAPH

Marcus Aurelius, *Meditations* 2.1. Each morning he expects to meet rude, ungrateful people, reminds himself they act from ignorance, and that we're made to work together.

BEFORE THE MEETING

Announce on your Substack. Remind people to keep examples anonymous: no names, no workplaces.

Open · 10	Read · 10	Discuss · 45	Practice · 15	Close · 10
Ground rules; keep it anonymous	Aloud, twice	The questions below	Write your own 2.1	One takeaway each

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

1. Marcus expects difficult people every morning. Is that pessimistic or practical?
2. Think of someone who frustrates you. What might they believe that makes their behavior make sense to them?
3. Does understanding someone mean excusing them?
4. In that relationship, what is actually in your control?
5. What does justice ask of you toward people you don't like?

PRACTICE THIS MONTH

Morning preparation. Before work, say your own version of 2.1: who you might meet today, and how you want to treat them.

FACILITATOR'S MOVE

"Is that always true?" When someone says "people like that never change," invite a counterexample.

NOTES